

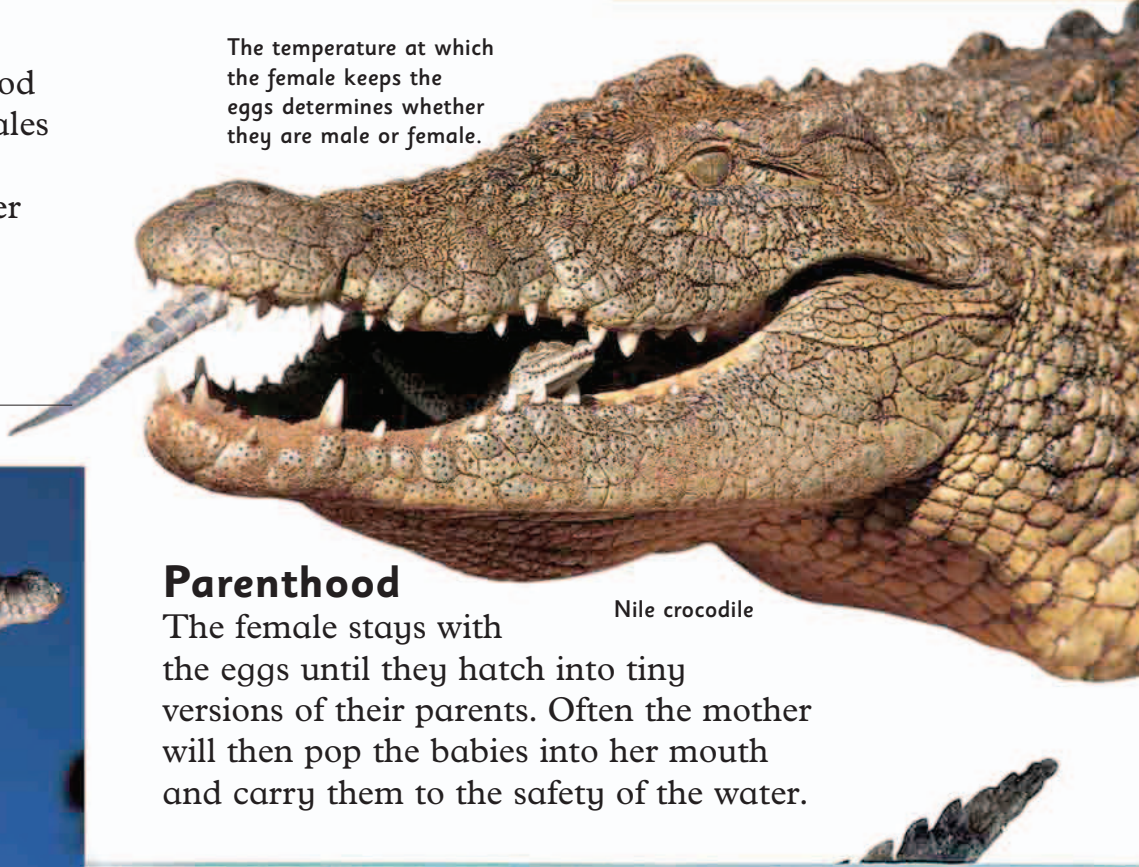
Parenting

Crocodilians make very good parents. Males attract females by bellowing and blowing bubbles. The female lays her eggs near the water and guards them fiercely.

Baby crocodile being carried by its mother



The temperature at which the female keeps the eggs determines whether they are male or female.



Nile crocodile

Parenthood

The female stays with the eggs until they hatch into tiny versions of their parents. Often the mother will then pop the babies into her mouth and carry them to the safety of the water.



They shake and tear meat.

Turn and learn

Other reptiles that enjoy the water – turtles:
pp. 84-85

Crocodiles and alligators only eat about 50 meals a year.

A large appetite

Crocodilians are some of the world's great meat-eaters. Often, like this crocodile, they wait at the water's edge for an animal to take a drink, then they attack, grabbing it with their massive jaws. They can kill animals bigger than themselves.